

MANIFESTING A REVOLUTION IN EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT: SMITI BHATT DEORAH'S JOURNEY FROM SILICON VALLEY TO BECOMING A GLOBAL HRTECH LEADER WITH ADVANTAGECLUB.AI

Smiti Bhatt Deorah, COO and Co-founder of AdvantageClub.ai is a pioneering force reshaping employee experience in corporates through technology and purpose. With a Master's in Computer Science from UCLA, Smiti began her career at Microsoft in the US, where she and her husband and co-founder, Sourabh Deorah, noticed a significant gap in employee recognition in South East Asia. They saw that employees needed more than basic perks—authentic appreciation and a sense of belongingness in the workplace.

Her expertise in B2B partnerships highlighted the importance of meaningful connections, yet her ambitions reached beyond Silicon Valley. Determined to make a real impact, she returned to India to start AdvantageClub.ai in 2016, initially focused on perks for SMEs. The startup's early years were challenging; by 2019, it faced critical obstacles. Committed to meeting the evolving workplace needs, Smiti and her team pivoted their model, expanding the platform to offer a full range of employee experience solutions for companies, including rewards and recognition, flexible benefits, well-being, surveys, and community-building tools.

When COVID struck, AdvantageClub.ai adapted swiftly to support a newly remote workforce, which proved to be a turning point. This resilience drove the company's exponential growth post-pandemic, and today, AdvantageClub.ai serves over 5 million users in more than 100 countries, with a client base exceeding 1,000.

Now a global leader in HR technology, AdvantageClub.ai also provides innovative solutions like Sales Contests and Incentive Automation, Channel Engagement, and Customer Loyalty programs. Guided by Smiti's principle, "If it's not useful to the end-user, it's probably not worth doing," AdvantageClub.ai has evolved from a startup into a multi-million-dollar global venture, setting a new standard in employee engagement.

As COO, Smiti manages key functions such as business development, customer relations, and content operations. Her visionary leadership has positioned AdvantageClub.ai at the forefront of technology-driven, empathetic employee experiences. For Smiti, genuine employee engagement is about creating an environment where employees feel seen and valued, moving beyond traditional benefits to emphasize holistic well-being.

Smiti's achievements have earned her numerous accolades, including "ET Inspiring Woman Leader," "Times Ascent Entrepreneur of the Year," and "BW BusinessWorld Disrupt Best Entrepreneur in Technology." She has been recognized as a thought



leader featured in YourStory's list of Women Entrepreneurs in Tech transforming the industry. She has shared her insights on TEDx, Josh Talks, Forbes India, SHRM, The Economic Times, and People Matters.

Central to Smiti's journey is her unwavering belief in the power of manifestation. For her, manifestation is a practice of fully immersing herself in her goals and aligning her focus to bring AdvantageClub.ai's vision to life. Beyond work, Smiti is now a proud mother, balancing her professional and family roles

and thriving in both spheres.

This exemplifies her strength and dedication, making her an inspiring role model for many. She enjoys reading about HR, tech, and the Indian startup ecosystem and has a self-confessed love for Harry Potter trivia. Smiti Bhatt Deorah's story is one of resilience, vision, and impact—a journey inspiring HR leaders, entrepreneurs, and professionals worldwide. Through AdvantageClub.ai, she exemplifies how innovation, empathy, and dedication can redefine the future of work.